

Shared Language — Lab 1 Job Aid

Fundamentals & Governance · keep this open during the lab. Terms are grouped by how you'll use them.

THE MAP — WHOSE WORD IS WHOSE

Every collision is a cross-frame problem. PMs live near the top; engineers near the bottom; the hand-off in the middle is where language breaks.

Studio 3.0 — product & business governance (Product Council, Evidence Locker, SoAR)	Mastercard
PDLC — product → engineering pipeline (PRD/MACS ... LLD ... stories)	Mastercard
AIDLC — how an AI agent executes inside the repo, under human gates	shared
The Workbench — the plugin you drive: skills · commands · sub-agents · rules · hooks · gates · journey	InRhythm · Arula
Industry substrate — LLM · agent · MCP · context window · TDD · idempotency	industry

SAME WORD, DIFFERENT ROOMS

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE VS. ELSEWHERE
Spec	Here “spec” = the tech spec at specs/refunds-s2i-phase1.spec.md — not the PRD or design spec. PMT-side spec authorship is out of scope for the series. PGS lineage: Solution Intent → Modelling → LLD (Spec-Craft output sits at LLD).
Gate	Three live meanings: the Workbench gate_guard that blocks a write · the human gate between every stage · Mastercard’s ARB / Product Council / quality gate .
Skill	A Workbench capability — not human skill. Say “intuition” or “practice” for the human side.
Sub-agent	The scoped, fresh-context planner / pr-reviewer — vs. “agent,” the general concept.
Plan	/p lan / the planner subagent’s task list — vs. program / PI planning, the org ceremony.

THE FIVE FAILURE MODES — THE VOCABULARY THE WHOLE SERIES REUSES (FIVE MODES, SIXTEEN FINDINGS)

MODE	PLAIN MEANING	IN THIS LAB
1 · Hallucination	Asserting behavior, fields, or dependencies no source supports.	Stage-4 dependency trap
2 · Correctly solving the wrong problem	A sound solution to something never in scope.	F3 — out-of-scope Void
3 · Incorrectly solving the right problem	The right feature, built with a gap the spec’s edge cases expose.	F2 — idempotency
4 · Sycophancy	A reviewer approves work because it already shares the author’s confidence.	F1 — auth code in logs
5 · Invented dependencies	A service or library added with no evidence it belongs on the path.	F4 — pre-risk client

F8 (a layering violation) is the one finding the build itself catches; the other fifteen are not. A green build tells you the code ran, not that it’s safe.

CORE TERMS — YOU’LL USE THESE IN THE LAB

TERM	MEANING	WHERE IT SHOWS UP
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Workbench	The plugin that wraps the runtime with engineering structure. A plugin, not a model.	Installed in Stage 0
Command	An explicit entry point you invoke to start a step.	/lab, /hand-off
Skill	A packaged, reusable capability the agent draws on for one type of work.	Workbench capabilities
Sub-agent	A scoped, fresh-context agent for one job — independent reasoning, limited tools.	planner, pr-reviewer
Rule	A static policy the Workbench always enforces.	payments-guardrails, ai-use-policy, coding-standards
Hook	An automated guardrail that fires deterministically at a trigger point.	journey_record, gate_guard
Gate	A deterministic control that blocks or refuses an action under defined conditions.	gate_guard (blocking); human gate each stage
Journey	Append-only, redacted audit trail of every tool call and event.	.claude/journey/
Hand-off	Closes one stage and carries structured context into the next.	/hand-off → workflow-tracker
Spec (tech spec)	The engineering-ready description of what to build and how correctness is verified. Not the PRD.	specs/...spec.md
Risk Register	The prioritized record of findings identified in the repo.	Stage 1 artifact
Non-negotiables	Fixed compliance/security constraints a build must honor.	e.g. null the auth code on retrieval
Judgment	Every material claim is a confirmed requirement, a documented assumption, or an unresolved ambiguity to escalate.	F5 (REFUND_EXPIRY): escalate, don't invent
Sycophancy	An agent (or person) reviewing its own work and approving it. Fresh context is the corrective.	Stage 4 pr-reviewer
Idempotency	Running the same operation twice must not double the effect.	F2 (no double refund)

MAPS TO YOUR WORLD (PGS)

Risk Register	Threat Risk Assessment (TRA)
Tech spec	Low Level Design (LLD)
Business truth	Solution Intent
Acceptance criteria	Given / When / Then
Non-negotiables	Engineering Standards

Mastercard reference frame (not taught in Lab 1): Studio 3.0, Product Council, Evidence Locker, SoAR, ARB, PDLC, AIDLC, PM-T, PRD/MACS, Definition of Ready/Done.

COMES LATER IN THE SERIES

Spec Craft	spec authoring — Lab 2
code-to-spec-validator	Lab 2+
clean-room-judge	Lab 2+
Repo Context Compressor	multi-repo — Lab 2

The Lab 1 spec ships pre-authored: this lab is comprehension and judgment against a real spec, not spec authoring.